understand that while the instinctive human reaction would be to protect the sub-identities one was closest to, the priority should be to preserve the civilisational tapestry and its foundations, which enabled the birth, growth and expression of diverse sub-identities. This also meant that protection of Indic civilisational integrity did not require the submergence of its sub-identities at the altar of a well-intentioned, albeit misplaced, grand unity project. On the contrary, history seemed to teach us that the survival of the Indic civilisation *as a civilisation* depended on the flourishing of its sub-identities, with each of the sub-identities realising that they were part of a federal symbiotic whole and that it was in their own existential interest to remain part of the whole. I also learnt that the tumultuous and fissiparous state of affairs that met the eye was the product of sustained long-term investment at a very fundamental level much before 1947. Therefore, it required, at the very least, an equally sustained long-term investment by the society at the most fundamental levels, namely the group and the individual, in order to undo the damage sustained by this living civilisation.

This realisation had a profound effect on me; however, I was not remotely sure of the path I had to take. Any drastic change in career paths required me to take the immediate family into confidence and convince them of my decision, and rightly so, because I had not given them the slightest inkling that I was going through a churn. But before breaking it to them, I wanted to be sure of the path myself, and so, I spent the seventh semester evaluating a career in civil services and alternatively, the law.

In early 2006, in my final semester, I had the opportunity to present a technical paper at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kharagpur. That is when I learnt that the institution was all set to inaugurate later that year a unique three-year LLB programme with an in-built specialisation in intellectual property rights under the auspices of its newly established law school, the Rajiv Gandhi School of Intellectual Property Law (RGSOIPL). What made the three-year law programme unique, apart from its marked tilt towards intellectual property law, was the fact that it was open exclusively to the scientific and technological pool of the country. I realised that my future lay in the field of law, which, I believed, would equip me with the skills I needed to act on my convictions. In July 2006, a month after my undergraduation, I joined the programme after clearing the admission process for the IIT law school.